

Stadion Strategic Messaging Framework

October 2025



Executive Summary

Research Intent

Overall, our research concluded that Stadion is a trustworthy and compliant player in the financial, fintech, and retirement solutions industries. Yet, their current messaging lacks human and relational strengths. Stadion's emphasis on regulatory expertise and management reflects reliability, but the heavy use of financial jargon and formal tones creates distance from users seeking understanding.

Key Findings

Strengths



Clear expertise



Longstanding
credibility



Centered on trust
and compliance

Weaknesses



Overly technical
language



Weak CTA's



Minimal Storytelling

Research Intent

Research Intent

This research aims to evaluate and refine Stadion Money Management's current website to enhance its communication with its audience effectively. The overall goal is to ensure that the messaging on the site communicates the brand's value proposition, differentiators, and human-centered approach. Stadion's current digital presence on its site demonstrates strength in value, trust, and compliance, but lacks clarity, emotional resonance, and accessibility for non-expert users.

Our goals

- Identify how Stadion's current messaging performs in communicating brand trust and relevance to its audiences - plan sponsors, advisors, and participants.
- Analyze competitor strategies to gain insights on clarity, tone, and overall engagement.
- Gather internal and external perspectives to understand perceived strengths and weaknesses.

Overall, this research intends to frame Stadion as a professional, user-centered brand that builds trust while also simplifying complex financial and technology concepts.

 Stadion

Brand Foundation

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Brand Foundation

Purpose:

Stadion's goal is to help retirement plan participants feel secure in their financial future. Stadion provides technology and investment strategies for plan sponsors, advisors, and participants.

The *deeper* purpose is to **enable confidence in financial futures**.

From Stadion's site, the focus is primarily on institutional compliance, rooting the company in reliability rather than accessibility. The goal here is to position Stadion with confidence, clarity, and the best resources for connection.

Vision:

“Custom solutions for retirement plan advisors, plans, and participants”.

With this value statement in mind, it is clear that Stadion is building resources to help everyone get connected and achieve trusted, transparent retirement solutions - we want to **build** off of this.

Brand Foundation

Values:

- Based on messaging patterns and brand tone, Stadions' values include: **trust**, **compliance**, and **partnership**.
- Stadion differentiates itself by leaning into the stability and strong partnerships it has to offer, which are extremely valuable but undercommunicated.

Trust: grounded in decades of compliance and expertise.

Compliance: promoting trustworthy, reliable services.

Partnership: partnering with client's to connect them to the best fitting service.

Brand Foundation

Voice:

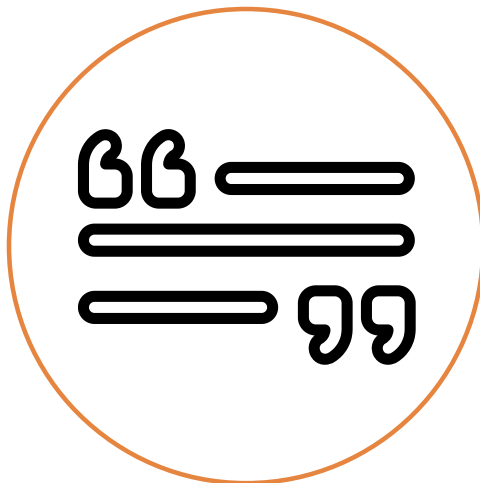
- The overall site presents a formal and corporate tone, which can easily alienate the everyday, non-expert, participant from understanding.
- We want to shift tone to → knowledgeable yet approachable by:



Avoiding
jargon



Using plain
language



Keep sentences
concise and
benefit-oriented

 Stadion
Audience Insights

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Audience Insights

Primary Personas:

- **Plan Sponsors**

- Plan sponsors want confidence that Stadion is a benefit to their employees and confidence that the partnership will be compatible.

- **Recordkeeper partners & advisors**

- Recordkeepers and advisors want the value ease of administration, compliance, and trust above all.
- They are looking to connect to the right sales person, see credibility signals, and quickly assess Stadion's offerings at a high level.

- **Participants**

- Participants value clarity and simplicity, they are looking to understand WHO is managing their money and visit the site to validate Stadion's legitimacy.

Industry pain points



Lack of trust



Confusion in
financial
terminology



Overload of
overwhelming
information

Audience Insights

Emotional Drivers:

Emotional drivers such as trust and confidence drive financial decisions more than logic.

We want to:

*Establish **trust**.*

*Provide **relief**.*

*Create **confidence**.*

Barriers and objectives:

High amounts of overwhelming jargon and overall distrust of financial institutions and providers. They alienate non-experts.

Unclear CTA's fail to move users down the funnel of the site.

Recommendation:

- Simplifying copy - using financial terms but in a clear, concise manner.
- Adding more proof of legitimacy and reliability
 - client & partner logos, testimonials, results.
- Using transparent CTAs
 - "Get in touch with our team"
 - "Talk with our team"
 - "Reach out to learn more"



Messaging Hierarchy

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Messaging Hierarchy

Purpose

The messaging hierarchy is a basis for Stadion's brand communication. It will help us ensure that all content from headlines to CTAs work together in a consistent, aligned manner. This messaging hierarchy will help establish clarity from the overarching brand narrative, down to the products and offerings. It will aid in preventing confusion and helping ensure communication is aligned across the board. The key questions asked here are:

- **Who** is Stadion?
- **What** do they offer?
- **Why** does Stadion matter?

Master narrative & value proposition

Currently, the master narrative and value proposition overlap, but they don't necessarily connect. One is emotional (using "we're with you for the long run"), and the other is rational ("custom solutions"). The goal is to tie them together into a cohesive layered message. We propose adding a tagline or connector to bridge the two with both emotion and clarity.

Messaging Hierarchy

Example hierarchy options

Option 1:

Master narrative:

"We're with you for the long run."

Tagline/Connector:

"Guiding every step of the retirement journey."

Value Proposition:

"Custom solutions for retirement advisors, plans and participants."

This options keeps Stadion's recognizable language but creates a more continuous storyline.

Option 2:

Master narrative:

"We'll help you invest in the long run."

Tagline/Connector:

"Custom solutions for retirement advisors, plans and participants."

Value Proposition:

"Built on trust. Designed for every stage of retirement."

This option is slightly more modern and clarifies what Stadion does right off the bat.

Messaging Hierarchy

Pillars

Pillar 1: trust and compliance

- Trust and compliance are the core differentiators of Stadion. The legitimacy of these is proved through longevity and Stadion's regulatory expertise.

Pillar 2: clarity and simplicity

- This pillar serves to solve user pain points. It will help in ensuring that Stadion's content and messaging is professional, yet clear.

Pillar 3: partnership and support

- This pillar emotionally connects Stadion to its clients, further differentiating itself from other tech-first competitors..

Supporting messages

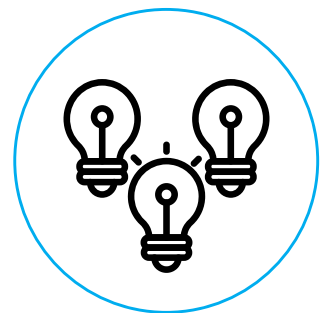
Implementing more of each of these elements will aid in supporting the pillars above.



Statistics



Customer
testimonials



Key
differentiators

 Stadion
Website Application

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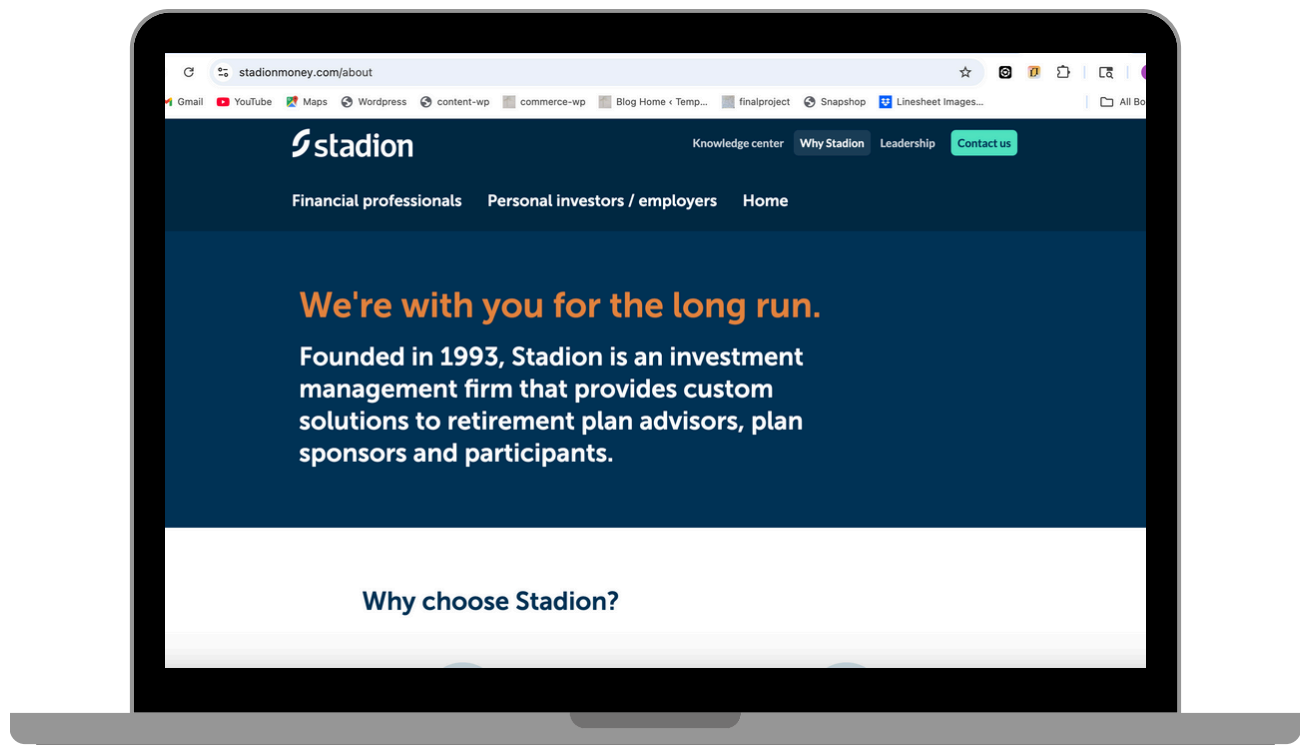
Website Application

About Page

Goal:

We want to implement updated elements of mission, the people behind the solutions, and purpose behind their offerings. Our overall goal is to tell the story of why stadion exists.

Current about page



Website Application

About Page

Proposed Updates:

Summary (in order of top of page to bottom):

- Small story/ “goal”
- A small team blurb
- Leadership / role icons with clickable buttons to take you to contact pages for each person on the team
- Trust-bages/ partner logos
- Small contact us form
- Section: Hero/ “Goal”
 - Heading:
 - “Helping you build confident retirement futures.”
 - Subheading/lead paragraph:
 - “Since 1993, Stadion has partnered with plan advisors, sponsors and participants to deliver custom investment strategies grounded in experience and driven by clarity.”
- Section: “Team blurb”
 - Heading:
 - “Our team, your partners.”
 - Subheading/ paragraph:
 - “We’re a group of investment professionals, technologists, and service specialists who believe that the best outcomes are produced when people and processes work together. Our purpose is to support your business, your team, and your participants along the way.”

Website Application

About Page

- Section: Leadership and contact buttons
 - Display a grid of leadership cards (name, role, short tagline) with an icon/button such as “contact [name]”
- Section: Partner logos & trust badges
 - Heading:
 - “Trusted by the industry.”
- Subheading:
 - “With over 30 years of experience and partnerships across the retirement industry, Stadion delivers trustworth results you can rely on.”
 - Provides industry proof and enforces credibility
- Section: Contact form
 - Heading:
 - “Lets talk about how Stadion can support your retirement strategy.”
 - Form fields:
 - Name, role (advisor/sponsor/participant), company, email, message sections
 - CTA: “Contact our team”
 - Add secondary contact information
 - Phone number and location (Athens)